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Could you explain the collaboration between T-Hub and Atal Incubation Centre (AIC)?

The Atal Innovation Mission, a special project under NITI Aayog, aims to establish incubators nationwide. There are 76 incubators, known as Atal Incubation Centres (AICs), with each state hosting one to two such incubators. Each incubator, focused on a particular sector, partners with a parent body, such as a university, another incubator, or a research entity. The AIC incubator, in collaboration with T-Hub, initially focused on healthcare. From there, we moved to the needs of electric vehicles and autonomous mobility and subsequently delved into green energy technologies and climate intelligence. Last year, we ventured into semiconductors after the global chip crisis. The incubator runs an exclusive annual incubation programme in each sector, selecting 20 to 25 companies from a pool of 400 to 500 startup applicants across India.

What is the mission or the objective of this entire collaboration?

We are a part of a nation-building exercise aspiring for India's advancement in innovation and entrepreneurship. The 76 AIC incubators are pivotal in various sectors across the country, including those in the northeast and Jammu and Kashmir. In Telangana, three AICs operate, specialising in social impact, sustainability along with us. AIC-T-Hub aims to grow startups so that they contribute to the GDP, innovation, and employment in the nation.

How would you define your overall success factor as an incubator?

AIC T-Hub nurtured 150+ startups in 5 sectors in the last 3 years: 54 products commercialised, 35 IPs generated, ₹140 million investment raised by startups, 70+ customer

pilots, and 1400 employments generated by startups. Two chips are taped out and fabricated from the very first cohort of AIC-T-Hub's Semicon programme. These criteria demonstrate our ability to accelerate the growth of these companies.

What partners or strategic alliances support AIC-T-Hub in its objectives?

We believe in co-incubation and collaborating with sector-specific institutions to grow startups. The collaborations include iCreate, Indian Semiconductor Mission (ISM), IIT SINE, T-works, Department of Emerging Technologies, and various Universities and Research bodies globally. We have partnered with T-Works, CITD, NSWAI, and EDS Technologies, providing our startups with efficient prototyping services. We have active engagement with prominent semiconductor companies such as ARM and NXP, and welcome mentors from diverse companies.

How many hardware startups have you incubated at T-Hub and how many of these are related to the electronics industry?

The predominant issues founders address typically involve a fusion of software and electronics. Though some companies focus solely on software solutions, most startups, spanning sectors like mobility, sustainability, agriculture, climate tech, or spacetech, leverage electronics to construct systems that efficiently confront the challenges they are addressing. Electronics are part of most MVPs.

How is this AIC-T-Hub fostering collaboration amongst semiconductor startups?

Semiconductor development is capital-intensive and technologically complex, requiring substantial mentorship. We establish connections with industry and research bodies in